CASM Onboarding: Default Guide + Skippable

Key assumptions + one-week plan | VVU CASM Android client (WP11) | one engineer + PM | 2026-11-01 | v0.1

Decision on the table: onboarding becomes a **default guide that is skippable** — shown automatically, skippable, resumable. On record: customer service worries users might get lost; development wants another round of event tracking first; ~35% activation is a stakeholder-stated target with no agreed definition; churn concentrates on day 1, cause unproven. Only those two numbers are carried forward — no baselines, rates or cohort sizes are invented anywhere. Week 1 ships instrumentation plus a flag-gated guide, one signed activation definition, a first baseline read — not proof of impact.

Key assumptions (to validate, not facts)

#	Assumption	Evidence status	Validated this week by
A1	Day-1 churn is caused by onboarding friction.	Hypothesis — timing observed, cause unproven.	Funnel from the new events; day-7 cohort review.
A2	A default, skippable guide cuts early drop-off without hurting experts.	Design hypothesis — no data either way yet.	guide_shown / skipped / step_completed split behind the flag.
A3	Users who skip and then get lost are detectable.	CS concern on record; no ticket data supplied.	guide_reopened count plus the CS onboarding-lost ticket tag.
A4	Activation is measurable once defined; ~35% is a target, not a baseline.	Uncertain metric — no agreed definition, no baseline.	Sign off one definition on D2; first baseline from D7 cohorts.
A5	One engineer ships instrumentation plus a flag-gated guide in one week.	Capacity assumption.	D4 end-to-end QA; reuse the telemetry pipeline only.
A6	Cohort-level reporting is enough for decisions.	Governance constraint — spec section 8.	Views suppress cohorts under 10; no person-level score fields.

One-week execution plan (one engineer + PM)

Day / Who	Action (resources in brackets)	Done when
D1 — PM + Eng	PM drafts three candidate activation definitions and the event list; engineer applies migration 0001 to the dev DB (db/0002 SQL, dev Postgres).	Definitions in writing; UPDATE/DELETE blocked; replay rejected.
D2 — Both	Sign off ONE activation definition + the nine event types; land the tracker behind a flag (db/0001 SQL, flag).	Definition recorded in an ADR; events emit in a debug build.
D3 — Eng + PM	Build the skippable guide (default on, Skip visible, reopen entry); PM writes CS playbook + ticket tag (helpdesk).	Guide renders; skip and reopen emit events; playbook with CS.
D4 — Eng + PM	QA on a test device: idempotency, seq replay, offline queue survives reboot; review copy (device, checklist).	QA checks pass; guide copy approved.
D5-7 — Both	Enable flag for a dogfood cohort (split in ADR); PM builds the dashboard; fix defects; book the D7 review (views).	Events visible with small-cohort suppression; review booked; limits stated.

Starter code shipped with this document (folder casm-onboarding-starter/): **db/0001_onboarding_event_tracking.sql** — append-only onboarding_events, replay guard on (device_id, seq), nine event types, skew classes; **db/0002_activation_candidates.sql** — three candidate activation views with small-cohort suppression, one becomes canonical on D2; **android/OnboardingEventTracker.kt** — persisted seq and idem_key per section 6, feeds the existing telemetry pipeline; **android/OnboardingGuideScreen.kt** — default-on, skippable, resumable Compose guide emitting UI events only.

Open decisions: canonical activation definition (D2), rollout split (D5), whether guide_skipped counts toward activation. The code files are skeletons — they parse; the Android files need the app project to compile.